Supervisor and University Contact System v1

Verified candidates, customised e-mail drafts, follow-up rules. 8 November 2026

Rules:

- **Nothing is sent without your approval.** You send every e-mail yourself, from your own address.
- **No funding is assumed** beyond what the university states in writing.
- Professors' research descriptions come from the universities' official pages (**E1**, read 7–8 Nov 2026).
- Before writing to anyone, open their profile, read **one recent paper or project**, and fill the `[⏳ paper]` line. A generic e-mail is worse than none.

Tracker: `Supervisor_Contact_Tracker_v1.xlsx`. One row per professor. It calculates follow-up dates and shows which e-mails are waiting.

1. Where a supervisor matters

Programme	Supervisor needed?	Official rule	Deadline
University of Manitoba MSc CS (thesis)	**Yes, before applying**	"Must have secured supervisor support before applying; supervisor support letter will be requested within the application" (E1)	**1 Dec 2026**. Go/no-go by 12 Nov
University of Calgary MSc CS (thesis)	**List at least one**	"We only consider students for which at least one of our professors has indicated that they will supervise the student." Contacting them is not required (E1)	Early review **15 Jan 2027**; final 1 Mar 2027; fee CAD 145
CSC universities (China)	Helpful, not always required	Pre-admission letter from the university is required (E2)	University deadlines Feb 2027
University of Saskatchewan (optional)	Not required to apply (E2)	–	Check
Sweden SI, AISS, EDISS, CMU-Africa	No	–	–

Funding stated by the universities (E1):

- **Manitoba:** all newly admitted CS graduate students are automatically considered for support, and **MSc students admitted to the program are funded at a minimum rate of $20,000 per year**. Supervisors may add more from grants.
- **Calgary:** funding comes from awards, graduate assistantships and loans. **No minimum is stated** on the page read.

Admission reality check:

- **Manitoba:** your Years 4–5 average is **2.98** against its 3.0 rule (borderline).
- **Calgary:** requires a supervisor to accept you, which is selective.
- Go ahead with either only if you can send 3–5 well-researched e-mails **this week**.

2. Candidate supervisors

2a. University of Manitoba, Department of Computer Science

#	Professor (title)	Research (official page, E1)	Fit with your work	Official contact (directory, E1)
M1	**Sogand Sadrhaghighi** (Assistant Professor)	**HiPe-Net Lab**: communication and security technologies for next-generation networks; networked systems from data centres to IoT	**Strong**: networks, security, data-centre operations	Sogand.Sadrhaghighi@umanitoba.ca
M2	**Ruppa (Tulsi) Thulasiram** (Professor)	**Computational Financial Derivatives Lab**: finance and computing	Moderate: finance + computing (his lab focuses on derivatives pricing and computation; your work is payment operations)	Tulsi.Thulasiram@umanitoba.ca
M3	**Parimala Thulasiraman** (Professor, Acting Department Head)	**IDEAS Lab**: parallel and distributed algorithms on high-performance, heterogeneous multicore architectures	Moderate: distributed systems	Parimala.Thulasiraman@umanitoba.ca
M4	Azadeh Tabiban, Shaowei Wang, Shaiful Chowdhury, Carson Leung	Research areas **not verified** here (the department lists FOCUS cybersecurity, software engineering and security, and database/data mining labs without naming leads)	Check each profile first	Directory e-mails (Firstname.Lastname@umanitoba.ca format as listed)

2b. University of Calgary, Department of Computer Science: Information Security and Systems

Profiles are on profiles.ucalgary.ca. Take the e-mail address from the profile page, which was not fetched here.

#	Professor	Research (official page, E1)	Fit with your work
C1	**Mahmoud Alfadel**	Software ecosystems, software releases, **build systems**, security vulnerabilities, mining software repositories	**Strong**: your CI/CD and release work
C2	**Kaisong Huang**	Database systems, **transaction processing**, data storage management, modern hardware for data systems	**Strong**: payment transaction platforms
C3	**Sara Rouhani**	**Distributed systems and cybersecurity**, decentralised architectures; secure, scalable, trustworthy computing	**Strong**: secure distributed platforms (also adjunct at Manitoba)

#	Professor	Research (official page, E1)	Fit with your work
C4	**Majid Ghaderi**	Design, optimisation and implementation of **network systems** and algorithms	Good: infrastructure and networking
C5	**Mea Wang**	Networking systems and algorithms, quality of service, overlay and peer-to-peer protocols	Good: service quality of networked systems
C6	Philip Fong	Access control models, policy languages, enforcement	Possible: your IAM/MFA exposure (only if you configured these)

Profile links (E1):

- profiles.ucalgary.ca/mahmoud-alfadel
- /kaisong-huang
- /sara-rouhani
- /majid-ghaderi
- /mea-wang
- /philip-fong

2c. Chinese universities (CSC Type B)

Write to the **international admissions office first** (draft 2a in `China_CSC/China_CSC_Application_Package_v1`). Write to a professor only after you find one whose recent work matches the study plan (draft 2b).

3. E-mail drafts (customise; send only after approval)

General rules:

- Subject line names the topic.
- Body under 170 words.
- One professor per e-mail.
- Attach your CV (PDF) and transcript.
- Do not attach large files.
- Never write “Dear Sir/Madam” to a professor.

M1: Dr Sadrhaghighi (Manitoba)

> **Subject:** Prospective MSc (thesis) student, Fall 2027: security of networked payment infrastructure
>
> Dear Dr Sadrhaghighi,
>
> I am a Computer Science graduate from Ethiopia working on the infrastructure of digital-payment services: Linux servers, deployment pipelines and monitoring [⏳ verified role and years]. The HiPe-Net Lab’s work on communication and security technologies for networked systems, from data centres to IoT, is close to the problems I face daily. I read

[⏳ paper title, year] and was particularly interested in [⏳ one specific point].

I would like to apply to the MSc (thesis) in Computer Science for Fall 2027 (deadline 1 December) and to work on [⏳ e.g. detecting attacks or failures in payment-network traffic]. Would you consider supervising me, if my background fits your group's plans?

My CV and transcript are attached (CGPA 2.62/4.00; final-year GPA 3.20; A− in Advanced Programming, Compiler Design and Complexity Theory).

Thank you for your time.

[Passport name]

C1: Dr Alfadel (Calgary)

Subject: Prospective MSc student, Fall 2027: software releases and build pipelines in fintech

Dear Dr Alfadel,

I maintain deployment pipelines and release processes for payment services at a fintech company in Addis Ababa [⏳ verified]. Your research on software releases, build systems and security vulnerabilities speaks directly to what I see in practice: [⏳ one real observation, e.g. dependency updates breaking builds]. I read [⏳ paper title, year] and [⏳ one specific reaction].

I plan to apply to the MSc in Computer Science (thesis) for Fall 2027 and would like to list you as a potential supervisor. Would you be open to considering my application? A possible direction: [⏳ e.g. how vulnerability fixes propagate through CI/CD pipelines in small engineering teams].

CV and transcript attached (CGPA 2.62/4.00; final year 3.20).

Thank you for your consideration.

[Passport name]

C2: Dr Huang (Calgary)

Subject: Prospective MSc student, Fall 2027: transaction processing for digital payments

Dear Dr Huang,

I work on the infrastructure behind digital payments in Ethiopia (POS, QR and payment-gateway services) [⏳ verified]. Your research on transaction processing and data storage management interests me because [⏳ one real reason from your work, e.g. peak-hour load on payment databases]. I read [⏳ paper title, year].

I am applying to the MSc in Computer Science (thesis) for Fall 2027. Would you consider supervising work on [⏳ e.g. reliability of transaction-processing systems under constrained hardware]?

CV and transcript attached (CGPA 2.62/4.00; final-year GPA 3.20).

Thank you,

[Passport name]

C3: Dr Rouhani (Calgary; adjunct at Manitoba)

> **Subject:** Prospective MSc student, Fall 2027: secure distributed systems for payments
>
> Dear Dr Rouhani,
>
> I am a Computer Science graduate working on payment-platform infrastructure in Ethiopia [⏳ verified]. Your work on secure, scalable and trustworthy distributed systems is directly relevant to the reliability and security problems of payment services in emerging markets. I read [⏳ paper title, year] and [⏳ one specific point].
>
> I am applying to the MSc in Computer Science (thesis) at Calgary for Fall 2027 [and to Manitoba, where you are adjunct]. Would you consider supervising me on [⏳ topic]?
>
> CV and transcript attached (CGPA 2.62/4.00; final year 3.20; Introduction to Distributed Systems B−; Computer Security B).
>
> Thank you,
>
> [Passport name]

For C4, C5, M2 and M3: use the M1 structure. Replace the research sentence with the professor's E1 description from section 2, and propose a topic that genuinely links your work to theirs.

4. Follow-up rules

Situation	Action
No reply after **7 days** (Manitoba) or **10 days** (Calgary)	One short follow-up in the same thread, then stop
Positive reply	Ask what the professor needs (CV, proposal, call); reply within 24 hours
"Not taking students"	Thank them; ask whether a colleague might be interested
Interview call	Prepare 2 minutes on your experience, 2 on your topic, 2 questions about their lab
Manitoba support letter	Enter the professor's details where the application requests the supervisor letter

5. Order of work (if you decide "go" by 12 Nov)

1. **Today–10 Nov:** read the profiles and one paper each for M1, C1, C2, C3; fill the `[⏳]` lines.
2. **Send** M1 (Manitoba, urgent) and C1–C3. Log each in the tracker.
3. **17 Nov:** follow up on M1 if no reply.
4. **By 25 Nov:** Manitoba support secured, or drop Manitoba.
5. **Dec–Jan:** Calgary application listing the professors who replied positively (or the best-fitting ones).